



Park Board General Manager's Report

March 30, 2026

The following report is intended to provide an overview and update on recent and upcoming activities within the Park Board.

Celebrating Vancouver's Cherry Trees: Festival Collaboration & Recent Plantings

The Park Operations Urban Forestry team is pleased to highlight ongoing collaboration with the Vancouver Cherry Blossom Festival and recent specialty tree plantings in David Lam Park and Queen Elizabeth Park.

At David Lam Park, the festival traditionally begins in the northwest corner with the flowering of the Akebono cherry trees. The 2021 heat dome significantly affected this grove, resulting in the decline of several trees. This year, the Team replaced six cherries with larger-caliper specimens to provide immediate visual impact and ensure festival visitors could continue enjoying the iconic blooms without interruption.

At Queen Elizabeth Park, a well-loved "Grandpa" cherry tree recently failed and required removal. To maintain the park's celebrated spring display, three new cherry trees were planted nearby. To enhance species diversity and stagger the flowering period, the Shirotae variety—commonly known as the Mt. Fuji cherry—was selected. This early-flowering ornamental tree produces distinctive double white blossoms. The newly planted cherries can be found along the pathway leading toward Bloedel Conservatory from the west parking lot, just north of the established Akebono trees currently in bloom.

These plantings reinforce the Park Board's commitment to preserving Vancouver's culturally significant cherry displays while proactively managing the urban forest for resilience and public enjoyment.

2026 Daisy Chin Woman of Inspiration Award

On March 5, staff at the Vancouver Board of Parks and Recreation gathered at Beach Avenue and online to celebrate the 2026 Daisy Chin Woman of Inspiration Award.

This annual award reflects the Park Board's commitment to fostering leadership and representation within our workforce, ensuring that women are empowered to contribute meaningfully both within our organization and in the broader community. We recognize and celebrate the women on our team to foster an inclusive environment where women feel a strong sense of belonging, opportunity, and empowerment.

The 2026 recipient is Katy Amon, a Senior Planner with the Planning and Policy team since 2016. She is a tireless advocate for the Park Board's mission, championing the preservation and growth of our park spaces with unwavering dedication. Katy leads by example, acknowledging the humanity in others while setting a high standard of excellence. Those who work with her feel inspired and fortunate.

This year's other panelists included Tina Fernandes - Project Manager II from Park Operations, Rachael Greenfield – Office Support Clerk III from Park Operations, and Melanie Ware - Clerk III from Recreation Services. 30 additional Park Board staff were also nominated by their peers.



Jody Taylor Memorial

March 31, 2026, marks the tenth anniversary of the passing of our colleague and Park Board arborist, Jody Taylor, who was fatally injured while working in Connaught Park.

Jody, 43 at the time of his passing, was a beloved father, an avid photographer, and a hard-core rock singer who loved life and lived it to the fullest. He was a valued member of our Park Board family and is deeply missed. A memorial tree and a dedicated bench stand in Jody's name near the entrance to Stanley Park on Beach Avenue, serving as lasting reminders of his life and legacy.

As we remember Jody, we are also reminded that safety is a shared responsibility. Each of us has a role to play—by working safely, following established procedures, identifying and mitigating hazards, and looking out for one another. Supporting our coworkers, speaking up when something doesn't feel right, and taking the time to do the job safely are essential parts of our work.

Let Jody's memory reinforce our commitment to safety so that we all go home at the end of the day to our families, friends, and loved ones.

Council Business (relating to or impacting parks & recreation):

Council to receive a report on March 31, 2026, titled "[Funding Application to Green and Inclusive Community Buildings Program](#)", which would endorse a funding application for the Champlain Heights Community Centre Energy Retrofit project for the amount of \$2.3M.

Council to receive a report on April 1, 2026, titled "[Contract Award for the Provision of a Recreation Management System](#)", which would authorize City staff to negotiate an agreement for the provision of a Recreation Management System for the Park Board with The Active Network.

Council to consider a motion on April 1, 2026, titled "[Fostering Inclusive and Diverse Democracy Through Harassment Prevention](#)", which would endorse the Elect Respect pledge and further calls on other elected officials, candidates, elector organizations, and community members to support the campaign.

Council to consider a motion on April 1, 2026, titled "[Creating a City of Vancouver Festival Support Fund](#)", which would direct staff to report back on the development of a fund designed to provide stable, transparent, multi-year financial support for qualifying cultural festivals and major public events.

Council to consider a motion on April 1, 2026, titled "[Establishing a City Comptroller By-law for Budget Efficiency and Asset Management Framework](#)", which would direct staff to report back on a draft Comptroller By-law to establish a City Comptroller as an independent oversight officer reporting directly to Council.



Board Briefing Memos and Emails: March 9 to March 30

Date	Topic
March 11	Hinge Park – Olympic Village Elementary School
March 13	2025 Preliminary Financial Results & 2026 Budget Implementation Update
March 18	2026 Outdoor Lifeguard Service – Update
March 23	Disc Golf Plan Process – Update
March 26	2026 Outdoor Pools Operational Plan – Update – Supplemental Information